

# W.A.R H.A.M.S

WORLD ACCESS RETRIEVABLE HEAVY ASSAULT MODIFIABLE SUITES

## THE BATTLE FOR PLANET X

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### Official Rulebook

*The corporations have spoken. The planet is rich. The orders are clear.  
Deploy your H.A.M.S, seize every resource, and crush anyone who stands in your way.  
There is no diplomacy — only Dominance.*

2–4 Players • Ages 14+ • 90–150 Minutes



# Section 1 — Introduction

**W.A.R H.A.M.S (World Access Retrievable Heavy Assault Modifiable Suites) — The Battle for Planet X is a sci-fi board game of corporate warfare, territorial control, and tactical betrayal for 2–4 players, ages 14+.**

Each player commands a private military force — squads of heavily armed soldiers known as H.A.M.S (Heavy Assault Modifiable Suites) — deployed by a rival megacorporation to conquer a distant, resource-rich alien world. Victory belongs to the corporation that accumulates the most Dominance Points (DP) by seizing territory, harvesting resources, arming their squads with powerful Basic Armament Cards (BACs), and manipulating the battlefield through cunning Conspire Cards.

The planet has no name — not yet. At the start of each game, players collectively choose a name for their battleground. Use the following naming convention to generate an alien-sounding designation:

Suggested Planet Name Format: 2 consonants + vowel + 2 consonants + vowel, optionally followed by Roman numerals.  
Examples: Nlendagru IV · Criftonba · Throskane II · Blentova IX This is just a suggestion — feel free to name your planet whatever you like!

Fight for resources. Fight for loyalty. Fight for the planet.

| Detail    | Value          |
|-----------|----------------|
| Players   | 2–4            |
| Ages      | 14+            |
| Play Time | 90–150 minutes |

## Section 2 — Components

### Hex Tiles (61 total)

The planet surface is built from randomized hexagonal tiles. Each tile represents a region of terrain or a key strategic installation.

| Hex Type            | Border Color | Count | Description                                         |
|---------------------|--------------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Oil Rig             | Black        | 3     | Produces Oil (Oil Drum) resources                   |
| Power Plant         | Yellow       | 3     | Produces Electricity (Lightning Bolt) resources     |
| Factory             | Red          | 3     | Produces Industry (Hammer) resources                |
| Radar Dish          | Blue         | 3     | Produces Intelligence (Transmitting Wave) resources |
| City / Village      | Green        | 3     | Produces Local Favor (Recruit) resources            |
| Separatist Base     | Grey         | 3     | Hostile NPC stronghold (printed numbers: 2, 4, 6)   |
| Spaceport Drop Zone | Purple       | 6     | Reinforcement landing sites (printed numbers: 1–6)  |
| Terrain Hex         | —            | 37    | Open ground, forests, craters, etc.                 |
|                     |              | 61    |                                                     |

### Number Tokens (16 total)

Number Tokens are placed on resource-producing Hexes during setup to determine which Hexes produce resources on a given dice roll. Note: Separatist Bases and Spaceport Drop Zones have their numbers printed directly on the tile and do not use Number Tokens.

| Number | Token Count |
|--------|-------------|
| 1      | 2           |
| 2      | 2           |
| 3      | 3           |
| 4      | 3           |
| 5      | 3           |
| 6      | 3           |
| Total  | 16          |

### Cards

| Card Type                  | Total | Breakdown           |
|----------------------------|-------|---------------------|
| BAC (Basic Armament Cards) | 100   | 20 types × 5 copies |
| Conspire Cards             | 72    | 24 types × 3 copies |

- BACs represent weapons, armor, gadgets, and upgrades equipped to your H.A.M.S.
- Conspire Cards represent political maneuvers, sabotage, intelligence operations, and tactical gambits.

### Resource Tokens (5 types)

Resources are the lifeblood of your campaign. Each type is produced by its corresponding Hex.

| Resource     | Color  | Depiction           | Token             | Token Colors                   |
|--------------|--------|---------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------|
| Oil          | Black  | Fuel                | Oil Drum          | Black on white, black border   |
| Electricity  | Yellow | Electricity Bolt    | Lightning Bolt    | Yellow on white, yellow border |
| Intelligence | Blue   | Intel Operator Room | Transmitting Wave | Blue on white, blue border     |
| Industry     | Red    | Industry Factory    | Hammer            | Red on white, red border       |
| Local Favor  | Green  | Militia Base        | Recruit           | Green on white, green border   |

## Dice

- 13 six-sided dice (d6) — used for combat, resource production, and event resolution.
- 1 Separatist Die (d6) — a distinct-colored d6 (grey) used as one of the 3 resource dice during Phase 1. Only this die triggers Separatist Base results: spawning at unconquered bases or Local Favor from conquered bases.

## Miniatures

| Component             | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| H.A.M.S Miniatures    | Soldier miniatures in 4 player colors — 28 per player (enough for 4 Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each). Each mini has 5 magnetized attachment points for the equipment slots (Head, Chest, Legs, Backpack, Hands). Each soldier sits on a 40mm magnetized round base printed with a squad letter and soldier number (A1–A7, B1–B7, C1–C7, D1–D7) and bearing 3 blood-drop divots for damage tracking.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Equipment Modules     | Physical miniature parts (helmets, chest plates, weapons, backpacks, leg armor) that magnetically attach to H.A.M.S minis. Each module corresponds to a BAC card type — e.g., a S.A.P (Standard Armor Plating) Helmet module, an H.C.A.R (Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle) rifle module. 8 copies of each module type exist (more than the 5 BAC cards per type, ensuring modules are available for re-equipping via the flag system). Each module has a unique sculpt per type and its abbreviation engraved on the underside for identification. When a BAC is equipped, its card is placed in the communal Equipment Display near the play area for all players to reference. The physical module on the mini is the source of truth for who has what equipped. |
| Separatist Miniatures | 24 grey NPC soldiers — used for Separatist spawns, base defenders, and militia                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

## Tokens & Accessories

| Component         | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Control Flags     | 25 small colored flag miniatures per player (one set per player color). Used to mark territorial control on hex tiles AND to mark equipped BAC types on the Equipment Display                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Cargo Containers  | 12 numbered plastic containers 2*(1–6) placed on spaceport hexes when BACs arrive. Matching containers near the board form the Unloading Zone where BAC cards that landed on a specific space port are stored                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Equipment Display | Shared area near the board where one copy of each BAC card is placed face-up as a reference. When a player equips a BAC type, place one of your Control Flags on that card to show your access. Multiple players' flags can be on the same card. Flags stay permanently — once placed, your flag is never removed, even if all your soldiers carrying that module die. It marks that you've unlocked that BAC type and can re-equip it |
| Damage Pegs       | Small red blood-drop pegs that snap into the divots on a soldier's base. Each base holds up to 3 pegs (4th wound = death).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Bunker Tokens     | Neutral fortifications placed by D.U.D.S (Deployable Unital Defense System): +1 all defense dice on hex. 1 per hex max. Any unit benefits. Destroyed by attacker winning combat on the hex                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Planet Frame      | Circular board edge made of 5 interlocking cardboard puzzle pieces that snap together to form the planet boundary. All 61 Hex tiles fill the entire interior.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

## Section 3 — Game Setup

Follow these steps in order to prepare the battlefield.

### Step 1 — Assemble the Planet Frame

Snap the 5 interlocking cardboard puzzle pieces together to form the circular Planet Frame. Place it on the table — this defines the boundary of the playable surface. Note the connection points labeled along the edges (a, b, c, etc.) — hexes at opposite edges sharing the same letter are adjacent for movement and range (the planet wraps around).

### Step 2 — Build the Planet

Shuffle all 61 Hex Tiles face-down. Place them randomly within the Planet Frame — tiles fill the entire interior of the circular board with no gaps. No peeking — the planet's geography is unknown until your forces make landfall.

### Step 3 — Reveal the Surface

Flip all Hex Tiles face-up. The planet is revealed. Take a moment to survey the terrain — note where the resources, Spaceport Drop Zones, and Separatist Bases have appeared.

### Step 4 — Place Number Tokens

Distribute the 16 Number Tokens across the 15 resource-producing Hexes (Oil Rigs, Power Plants, Factories, Radar Dishes, and Cities/Villages). Separatist Bases and Spaceport Drop Zones already have their numbers printed on the tile and do not receive Number Tokens.

| Number | Tokens Available | Placement                 |
|--------|------------------|---------------------------|
| 1      | 2                | Place on 2 resource Hexes |
| 2      | 2                | Place on 2 resource Hexes |
| 3      | 3                | Place on 3 resource Hexes |
| 4      | 3                | Place on 3 resource Hexes |
| 5      | 3                | Place on 3 resource Hexes |
| 6      | 3                | Place on 3 resource Hexes |

Place them randomly. One Hex will receive two Number Tokens (since there are 16 tokens for 15 Hexes) — that Hex triggers on either number but still produces only 1 resource per roll (not double). This makes it a strategic hotspot that activates more often without snowballing resources.

### Step 5 — Prepare the BAC Cards

Shuffle all 100 BAC Cards into a single face-down pile. Then:

1. Deal 3 BAC Cards face-down to each player. Players look at their cards but keep them secret.
2. Each player chooses 1 card to keep and passes the remaining 2 cards face-down to the player on their left.
3. From the 2 cards received, each player chooses 1 card to keep and passes the last card to the left.
4. Each player keeps the final card received. All players now have a starting hand of 3 BAC Cards.
5. Place the remaining deck near the board — this is the Spaceport Deck.
6. Turn 6 cards face-up in a row beside the Spaceport Deck — this is the Planet Bound Area.

Always maintain 6 face-up cards in the Planet Bound Area. Whenever a card is taken from it, immediately replace it from the Spaceport Deck.

### Step 6 — Prepare the Conspire Deck

Shuffle all 72 Conspire Cards and place them face-down near the board as the Conspire Deck. Do not deal any Conspire Cards during setup — they are only acquired during play.

### Step 7 — Muster Your Forces

Each player takes the following in their chosen color:

- 10 H.A.M.S Miniatures (organized into 2 Squads of 5 soldiers each, e.g. A1–A5 and B1–B5)
- A pool of damage pegs kept beside the play area

Additional H.A.M.S are recruited during the game. You may eventually command up to 4 Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each (28 total).

Step 8 — Determine First Player

The oldest player takes the first turn. Play order proceeds clockwise from the first player.

Step 9 — Squad Placement (Snake Draft)

Players deploy their starting Squads to the planet surface using a snake draft. H.A.M.S drop from orbit — landing zones must be clear of hostile forces and away from critical infrastructure to avoid casualties and collateral damage.

| Order   | Action                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Round 1 | Starting with the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player places their 1st Squad on any unoccupied Terrain Hex (not resource hexes, Spaceports, or Separatist Bases).                    |
| Round 2 | The last player in Round 1 immediately places their 2nd Squad on any unoccupied Terrain Hex. Then placement continues counter-clockwise, ending with the first player placing their 2nd Squad last. |

Step 10 — Set Up the Unloading Zone

Place one set of 6 numbered Cargo Containers (1–6) in a row near the board — this is the Unloading Zone. Keep the second matching set of containers nearby.

When BAC cards arrive at spaceports during the game (via doubles/triples):

1. Place the BAC card face-up in the Unloading Zone under the container matching that spaceport's printed number. If BACs already exist in that slot, stack them face-up under the same container.
2. Place the matching container from the second set on the corresponding spaceport hex on the board to mark the delivery (if not already there).

**Collecting BACs: During Phase 5, a Squad occupying a spaceport hex with a container marker may collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into their hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the Unloading Zone slot.**

Step 11 — Stock the Supply

Set up a resource supply area beside the board. Sort all Resource Tokens by type into clearly separated piles so any player can easily access them.

Note — Every Planet Is Different! The random Hex placement during setup ensures that no two games of W.A.R H.A.M.S are alike. The geography of your planet, the location of critical resources, and the proximity of Separatist threats will change every session. Adapt your strategy — or be crushed.

# TURN STRUCTURE

Starting from the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player completes all seven phases of their turn before play passes to the next player. No other player may act during your turn unless a Conspire Card, combat, or Phase 4 resource gathering (for combat participants) specifically requires it.

## Phase 1: Resource Production

The active player rolls 2d6 + 1 Separatist Die (a grey d6). All three dice produce resources normally — for each unique number rolled, place 1 corresponding resource token on every hex tile bearing that number token. Duplicate dice do not produce extra resources — rolling the same number twice still produces only once for that number. This includes hexes currently occupied by Separatist forces.

Example: You roll 2, 4, and the Separatist Die shows 6. Every hex with a "2", "4", or "6" number token receives 1 resource token of its type. Example (Doubles): You roll 3, 3, and the Separatist Die shows 5. Every hex with a "3" token receives 1 resource token (not 2 — duplicates don't double production), and every hex with a "5" token receives 1 resource token. The doubled 3s also trigger a BAC delivery (see Doubles below).

**Separatist Base Result — After producing resources, resolve the grey Separatist Die using Phase 7: Separatists — Base Results. A matching unconquered base spawns Separatists; a matching conquered base instead gives 1 Local Favor directly to its controller. The player who rolled the die does not matter. Newly spawned forces remain at their base until Phase 7.**

**Doubles — If two of the three dice show the same number (e.g., 3, 3, 5):**

- Take the BAC card from the Planet Bound Area whose position matches the doubled number (e.g., double 3s = the 3rd card in the row). Place it face-up in the Unloading Zone container slot matching that number, and place the matching numbered container on the spaceport hex with that printed number on the board. Multiple BAC cards may accumulate at a single Unloading Zone slot over successive turns.
- All unique numbers rolled still produce resources normally (the BAC delivery is an additional bonus, not a replacement).

**Triples — If all three dice show the same number (e.g., 4, 4, 4):**

- The active player chooses which spaceport drop zone on the board receives a BAC card. Take the BAC card from the Planet Bound Area whose position matches the tripled number (e.g., triple 4s = the 4th card). Place it face-up in the Unloading Zone container slot matching the chosen spaceport's printed number, and place the matching container on that spaceport hex.
- Additionally, the active player may move any single open (face-up) BAC from the Planet Bound Area to any Unloading Zone container slot of their choice.

Tip: Triples are rare but powerful — choosing which spaceport receives a BAC card lets you funnel valuable equipment toward your controlled zones or deny it to opponents.

## Phase 2: Movement

The active player may move each of their Squads. Each individual H.A.M.S in a Squad may move up to 1 hex in any direction. A soldier equipped with Jump Jets (J.J) may move up to 2 hexes instead.

Soldiers within a Squad move independently — they are not required to stay grouped. Spreading out allows a Squad to cover more hexes for resource gathering, but isolated soldiers are vulnerable to attack. However, every soldier must remain within 2 hexes of at least one other squadmate at all times (squad coherency).

Exception — Jump Jets (J.J): A soldier equipped with J.J may move beyond squad coherency range, explicitly overriding the 2-hex rule. While disconnected (beyond 2 hexes of all squadmates), the soldier fights alone — rolling only their own dice with no squad support. They cannot benefit from Squad-level BAC effects (e.g., S.L.I.M.E (Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment) crew, L.P.M (Laser Pointer Marker) spotting). The soldier may rejoin their Squad by moving back within 2 hexes of a squadmate on a later turn.

Example: A 5-soldier Squad on hex A could split: 2 soldiers stay on hex A, 1 moves to hex B, and 2 move to hex C. All five remain part of the same Squad — A is 2 hexes away from C, maintaining coherency.



**Moving Through Separatists —** A soldier may not move through a hex occupied by Separatist forces without engaging them in combat first (see Phase 3).

**Board Wrapping —** The planet is round. Hexes at the edges of the board connect to corresponding hexes on the opposite edge via marked connection points (labeled a, b, c, etc.). Movement and range calculations wrap accordingly.

### Alternative: Conspire

Instead of moving a Squad, the active player may forfeit that Squad's movement to Conspire (see the full Conspiring section for details):

1. Draw 3 cards from the Conspire Deck.
2. Keep 1 card and discard the other 2 face-down to the Conspire discard pile.
3. If a drawn card states otherwise (e.g., "keep 2"), follow that card's instructions instead.

A player may choose to move some Squads and Conspire with others — the choice is made per Squad. A Squad may also forfeit its Combat in Phase 3 to Conspire instead (see Phase 3).

Tip: Conspiring is your primary path to powerful one-time effects, resource conversion, and combat tricks. Don't neglect it — a well-timed Conspire Card can turn the tide of battle.

### Claim Hexes (end of Phase 2)

After all of your Squads have finished moving, for every hex containing one or more of your soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place one of your Control Flags on that hex. If an opposing flag is already there, return it to that opponent's supply and replace it with yours. If your own flag is already there, leave it. Flags on hexes you do not currently occupy remain in place until an opponent later claims them by this same rule — the planet stays painted in your colour even after your Squad moves on.

Hexes containing both your soldiers AND an enemy's are contested — no flag is placed (or changed) at this step. Wait until Phase 3 Combat resolves who occupies the hex; the Claim Hexes step at the end of Phase 3 will then settle the flag.

## Phase 3: Combat

If any enemy units — whether belonging to other players or Separatist forces — are within 2 hexes of the active player's soldiers, the active player may declare combat. Declaring combat during Phase 3 is optional; Separatist combats triggered during Phase 7 are mandatory (see Phase 7: Separatists — Combat Rules). Only engaged soldiers (within 2 hexes of the target) participate and roll dice.

To declare combat:

1. The active player states which of their Squads is attacking.
2. The active player designates which enemy Squad (or Separatist group) is the target.
3. Resolve combat according to the full Combat section below.

**Multiple Combats —** If the active player has multiple Squads engaged with different enemy forces, each may declare a separate combat. Resolve combats one at a time, in the order chosen by the active player.

**Alternative: Conspire —** Instead of declaring combat with a Squad, the active player may forfeit that Squad's attack to Conspire (draw 3 Conspire Cards, keep 1). The choice is made per Squad — some Squads may fight while others Conspire.

Note: Only the active player may initiate combat during this phase. Defending players respond as part of combat resolution but do not initiate attacks of their own.

### Claim Hexes (end of Phase 3)

After all combats are resolved, re-run the Claim Hexes step exactly as in Phase 2: for every hex containing one or more of your soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place your Control Flag (return any opposing flag to its owner's supply). This catches the hexes that combat just cleared — for example, a hex you successfully attacked and pushed the defender off, or a contested hex where your soldiers survived and the opponent's didn't.

If a base was conquered this phase (all 7 base defenders killed), the conquering player places their flag on the base hex as part of this step.

## Phase 4: Salvage & Resource Gathering

After all combats are resolved, the active player collects resources from the board. If combat occurred this turn, any defending player involved in that combat also collects resources during this phase.

### Priority Order:

- If combat occurred: the combat winner picks first, then the loser. If neither side was clearly victorious (equal damage dealt), the active player picks first.
- If no combat occurred: only the active player collects.
- If multiple combats occurred, resolve collection per combat in the order chosen by the active player. A player involved in multiple combats still only collects once, using their best priority.

Quick Priority Reminder: \$` Combat winner -> \$a Combat loser -> \$b Active player (if no combat or tie). One collection per player.

### Step 1 — Salvage Collection (if any):

Before collecting resources, any player whose soldier occupies a hex containing salvage modules (left behind after a death — see Death in W.A.R H.A.M.S, Step 4) may pick them up. Salvaged modules can be equipped for free — simply attach the module to the soldier's miniature. Salvage collection follows the same priority order listed above.

A player may choose to forfeit their salvage pickup and instead collect 1 resource token from the same hex during this step. This counts as their collection for the turn — they do not collect again in Step 2.

### Step 2 — Resource Collection:

- Each soldier may pick up 1 resource token from the hex they currently occupy.
- A soldier equipped with B.E.A.R (Battlefield Extraction Airlift Rover) may pick up 1 additional resource token of any type from the same hex.
- Continue in priority order until all accessible resources have been claimed or no player wishes to collect further.

Important: Resources cannot be collected from a hex occupied by Separatist units. Defeat them first.

Collected resource tokens go directly into the player's personal supply.

Note: Only the active player and players who participated in combat this turn may collect. Players not involved in combat wait for their own turn.

## Phase 5: Purchase & Equip

The active player may unlock and equip BAC types, acquire new BAC cards, recruit soldiers, and create new Squads. All actions in this phase may be performed in any order and any number of times (resources permitting).

### Equipping a BAC:

There are two ways to equip a BAC — unlocking a new type, or re-equipping a type you've already unlocked.

#### Unlocking a new BAC type:

1. Choose a BAC card from your hand and place it face-up in the Equipment Display (shared reference area near the board). If the card is already in the Display, discard your copy instead.
2. Place one of your Control Flags on that card in the Equipment Display — this marks that you have permanently unlocked this BAC type.
3. Pay the card's resource cost for each soldier you wish to equip.
4. Attach the matching equipment module (magnetized part) to each equipped soldier's miniature in the correct slot (Head, Chest, Legs, Backpack, or Hands).

Equipping has no location requirement — you may equip any of your soldiers regardless of where they are on the board. Soldiers recruited this phase may also be equipped immediately.

#### Re-equipping an unlocked BAC type:

If your Control Flag is already on a BAC card in the Equipment Display, you may equip additional soldiers with that type at any time during Phase 5 — no card needed, just pay the resource cost per soldier and attach the module.

**Limit: Only 8 copies of each equipment module exist in the game. If all 8 are currently in use, no more soldiers can equip that type until a module is freed (destroyed modules return to the box and can be purchased again).**

Example: You have an H.C.A.R (Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle) card in hand. You place it in the Equipment Display and put your red flag on it — H.C.A.R is now unlocked for you permanently. You pay 1 Industry + 1 Oil per soldier and snap H.C.A.R rifle modules onto their Hands slot. Next turn, you recruit a new soldier and want to arm them too — just pay 1 Industry + 1 Oil again, no card needed.

### **Acquiring New BACs:**

- Spaceport Deck Purchase: Spend 3 resource tokens of any single type while your Squad is at or adjacent to a Spaceport or City -> draw 1 face-down card from the Spaceport Deck into your hand.
- Spaceport Drop Zone Collection: If a Squad occupies a spaceport hex with a container marker, collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into your hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the slot.

### **Recruiting New Soldiers:**

Pay 1 Local Favor + 1 Oil + 1 Industry + 1 Electricity while your Squad is in or adjacent to a City -> add 1 H.A.M.S to that Squad.

- Maximum 7 soldiers per Squad.

### **Creating New Squads:**

Pay the soldier recruitment cost × the number of soldiers in the new Squad (minimum 5 soldiers to form a Squad).

- Maximum 4 Squads per player.
- The new Squad is placed at the City where it was recruited.

Example: Creating a new 5-soldier Squad costs  $5 \times (1 \text{ Local Favor} + 1 \text{ Oil} + 1 \text{ Industry} + 1 \text{ Electricity}) = 5 \text{ Local Favor} + 5 \text{ Oil} + 5 \text{ Industry} + 5 \text{ Electricity}$ .

## **Phase 6: Trade**

The active player may trade resource tokens freely with any other player. Both parties must agree to the terms of the trade. There is no limit to the number of trades per turn.

- Only resource tokens may be traded. BAC cards, Conspire Cards, and equipment cannot be traded.
- All trades must be two-sided — both players must give and receive at least 1 resource token. No gifting or taking resources for free.
- Trades must be executed immediately — no promises of future payment or deferred trades are enforceable.
- Bank Trade: You may trade with the supply at a 3:1 ratio — return 3 of any single resource type to the supply and take 1 of any other type. No limit on bank trades per turn.

Example: Trading 1 Oil for 1 Electricity with another player is valid. Giving 1 Oil for nothing in return is not. If no one will trade, you can return 3 Oil to the supply and take 1 Electricity from the bank.

## Phase 7: Separatists

Separatists are rogue fighting forces loyal to no corporation — remnants of failed colonial garrisons, opportunistic raiders, and alien sympathizers who resist all outside control. This phase contains all rules for their components, spawning, behavior, combat, and bases.

### Components & Bases

- The game has 24 grey Separatist miniatures, shared by roaming forces, base defenders, and militia.
- The three Separatist Bases have 2, 4, and 6 printed on their tiles. They never receive Number Tokens.
- Whenever a rule would spawn more Separatists than remain in the supply, spawn as many as possible. Any excess spawn is lost.

### Separatist Base Results (Phase 1)

During Phase 1, compare the grey Separatist Die with the printed number on each Separatist Base:

- Unconquered matching base: Spawn 3 Separatists on that base.
- Conquered matching base: Its controlling player immediately gains 1 Local Favor from the supply instead. This happens regardless of which player rolled the die and does not require all three bases to be conquered.

The other two resource dice never trigger either result.

Spawned Separatists remain on the base. Do not consume resources, move them, or resolve their combat until Phase 7. A conquered base no longer spawns naturally.

### Phase 7 Procedure

The active player resolves all four steps below for every Separatist on the board, regardless of territory. This includes Separatists spawned during the current turn's Phase 1 and those spawned by Instigate Uprising.

#### Step 1 — Instigate Uprising

Each player who controls a conquered Separatist Base may pay 3 Local Favor to spawn 3 Separatists at any one unconquered base. This ability may be used once per round per conquered base that player controls. Spawned forces stay at the target base until Step 3.

#### Step 2 — Consume

Every Separatist occupying a hex with one or more resource tokens removes 1 token from that hex. Return removed tokens to the supply and resolve all consumption simultaneously.

#### Step 3 — Move

Resolve Separatists one at a time. Each may move up to 3 hexes, following this priority:

1. Look within 3 hexes for any resource-producing hex (Oil Rig, Power Plant, Factory, Radar Dish, or City/Village) containing at least 1 resource token.
2. If one or more qualify, choose the hex containing the most resource tokens. The active player breaks ties.
3. If none qualify, choose the nearest resource-producing hex, even if it is empty. The active player breaks ties. Move up to 3 hexes toward it; continue on a later turn if it is farther away.

**BAC cards and cargo containers are not resources and are never movement targets. A Spaceport Drop Zone does not attract Separatists merely because it contains a cargo container or BAC delivery.**

A Separatist already on its chosen target moves 0 hexes. Each adjacent step counts as 1 hex. Finish moving every Separatist before beginning Step 4.

Tip: A producing hex with many tokens attracts every Separatist that selects it under this priority. Clearing valuable piles near your forces can redirect the swarm.

#### Step 4 — Resolve Combats

Resolve mandatory combat on every hex shared by Separatists and player soldiers. The defending player fights normally; the player to the defender's left rolls the Separatist dice. Resolve contested hexes clockwise, starting from the active player.

## Combat Rules

| Rule             | Detail                                                                                              |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rolled By        | The player to the left of the player fighting the Separatists rolls every Separatist die            |
| Roaming Penalty  | Roaming Separatists apply -1 to all dice, to a minimum result of 1                                  |
| Base Defenders   | Base defenders roll a full d6 and do not apply the roaming -1 penalty                               |
| Hit Points       | Each Separatist has 1 life; any hit kills it immediately                                            |
| Player Attacks   | A player may voluntarily attack a Separatist group during Phase 3 under the normal engagement rules |
| Mandatory Combat | Combat is mandatory after Separatists enter a player's hex during Phase 7                           |
| Blocking         | A player must defeat Separatists before moving through their hex or collecting resources there      |

## Conquering Bases

- The first attack against an unconquered base triggers 7 base defenders. They are dug in and roll full d6 without the roaming penalty.
- Defeat all 7 defenders to conquer the base, then place your Control Flag on its hex.
- Surviving defenders become roaming Separatists and follow the Phase 7 procedure.
- Conquered bases stop spawning naturally (their printed number no longer triggers spawns).
- The controller gains the Instigate Uprising ability described in Step 1.
- Whenever the Separatist Die matches a conquered base's printed number, that base's controller immediately gains 1 Local Favor, regardless of who rolled the die.

Warning: Don't attack a base unless you can handle all 7 defenders! Survivors scatter toward resource hexes.

## End of Turn

Once all seven phases are complete, play passes clockwise to the next player, who begins their turn at Phase 1.

## End of Round

A round is one full cycle of all players' turns (each player completes Phases 1–7 once). After the last player in turn order finishes their turn, resolve the following before the next round begins:

- Any uncollected resource tokens remaining on hexes you control (marked with your Control Flag) are added to your personal supply.
- Any spaceport hexes you control that have a container marker on them: collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into your hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the slot.

Then a new round begins with the first player.

## Turn Summary — Quick Reference

| Phase | Name                         | Summary                                                                                                                         |
|-------|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Resource Production          | Roll 3d6, spawn resources on matching hexes. Doubles/triples = BAC drops at spaceports                                          |
| 2     | Movement                     | Move each soldier up to 1 hex (2 with J.J). Alternatively, Conspire instead of moving a Squad                                   |
| 3     | Combat                       | Declare attacks against enemies within 2 hexes. Only engaged soldiers (within 2 hexes of target) roll dice                      |
| 4     | Salvage & Resource Gathering | Salvage modules from current hex first, then collect resource tokens. Priority: winner -> loser -> active player (if no combat) |
| 5     | Purchase & Equip             | Spend resource tokens to buy and equip BACs, recruit soldiers, or create new Squads                                             |
| 6     | Trade                        | Trade resource tokens freely with other players by mutual agreement                                                             |
| 7     | Separatists                  | Uprising -> consume -> move -> combat                                                                                           |

# COMBAT SYSTEM

Steel meets steel. Dice hit the table. Only one side walks away whole.

Combat is the heart of W.A.R H.A.M.S. When corporations clash over hexes, resources, and dominance, the battlefield is decided through a structured sequence of dice rolls, tactical assignments, equipment bonuses, and card play.

## Initiating Combat

During Phase 3 of the active player's turn, they may declare an attack with any of their Squads against an enemy Squad (or Separatist group). This is separate from mandatory Separatist combat during Phase 7 (see Phase 7: Separatists — Combat Rules).

**Base Range — No Equipment Required:** Every H.A.M.S has a base combat range of 2 hexes, even with nothing equipped in its Hands slot or any other slot. This includes enemies on the same hex, an adjacent hex, or 2 hexes away. An unequipped soldier may attack and defend normally, rolls 1d6, and counts as engaged within that range. Equipment changes this only when its rule explicitly modifies range or dice.

- Each Squad may declare one attack per turn.
- To initiate combat, at least one of the attacking Squad's soldiers must be within 2 hexes of at least one soldier in the target Squad.
- Engaged soldiers only: Only soldiers within 2 hexes of at least one enemy soldier in the target Squad participate in combat and roll dice. Soldiers outside this range sit out — they do not roll attack or defense dice.
- S.L.I.M.E (mortar) has extended range and may fire from beyond 2 hexes (up to 3 hexes). Mortar crew count as engaged even if outside normal range. B.A.S.R (Bolt Action Sniper Rifle) fires at up to 2 hexes in a pre-combat step — within normal engagement range, but its range can be extended via L.P.M (Laser Pointer Module) (up to 4 hexes). See Special Weapon Rules below.
- Only the active player may initiate combat. Defenders respond during combat resolution but do not choose to attack on another player's turn.

## Combat Resolution — Step by Step

Once combat is declared, resolve it by following Steps 1 through 6 in order.

### Step 1: Roll Attack & Defense Dice

Both players roll simultaneously.

- Attacker rolls 1d6 for each engaged H.A.M.S in the attacking Squad (only soldiers within 2 hexes of the enemy, plus any with extended-range weapons).
- Defender rolls 1d6 for each engaged H.A.M.S in the defending Squad.

### Dice Advantage Rule

When one side has more soldiers than the other, the side with more soldiers still rolls dice equal to their full soldier count. However, only a number of dice equal to the smaller Squad's size are used in matchups. The player with more dice selects their best dice (highest values) to assign.

The extra dice provide more options — not more attacks or defenses. The number of matchups is always equal to the smaller Squad's soldier count.

**Worked Example — Attacker Outnumbers Defender:** A 5-soldier Squad attacks a 3-soldier Squad. - Attacker rolls 5 dice: 1, 1, 5, 5, 6 - Defender rolls 3 dice: 4, 4, 2 - The smaller Squad has 3 soldiers, so there are 3 matchups. - Attacker picks their best 3 dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender must use all 3 of their dice: 4, 4, 2 - Attacker assigns matchups: 6->4, 5->4, 5->2 — all three defenders are hit!

**Worked Example — Defender Outnumbers Attacker:** A 3-soldier Squad attacks a 5-soldier Squad. - Attacker rolls 3 dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender rolls 5 dice: 1, 1, 4, 4, 2 - There are 3 matchups (equal to the smaller Squad). - Attacker must use all 3 of their dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender picks their best 3 from 5 dice: 4, 4, 2 - Matchups: 6->4, 5->4, 5->2 — still hits, but the defender had more choices to select their strongest defense dice.

## Step 2: Assign Dice (Attacker Chooses Matchups)

After both sides have selected their dice, the Attacker assigns matchups. This is one of the most tactically important moments in combat.

1. The Attacker places each of their selected attack dice in front of a specific defending H.A.M.S miniature. Each defending soldier receives exactly one attack die.
2. The Defender then assigns their defense dice, placing one defense die next to each attack die.

Each matchup is now a one-on-one comparison:

| Comparison                | Result                                   |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Attack die > Defense die  | HIT — the difference equals damage dealt |
| Attack die <= Defense die | BLOCKED — no damage is dealt             |

Worked Example — Dice Assignment: Attacker rolls: 6, 4, 1 — Defender rolls: 5, 4, 6 The Attacker assigns:

| Target    | Attack Die | Defense Die | Result                         |
|-----------|------------|-------------|--------------------------------|
| Soldier A | 6          | 5           | HIT (6 - 5 = 1 damage)         |
| Soldier B | 4          | 4           | BLOCKED (tie goes to defender) |
| Soldier C | 1          | 6           | BLOCKED (defense wins)         |

Total: 1 hit dealing 1 damage peg to Soldier A. Note: The Attacker chose to throw their 6 at Soldier A. A different assignment would have changed the outcome entirely. Choose your matchups wisely.

## Step 3: Apply Equipment Bonuses

After initial dice placement, both sides apply bonuses from equipped BAC cards. Bonuses modify the face value of dice already placed — they do not add additional dice.

1. Attacker applies attack bonuses first (e.g., H.C.A.R grants +1 attack to the equipped soldier's die).
2. Defender applies defense bonuses second (e.g., S.A.P armor grants +1 defense to the equipped soldier's die).

Equipment bonuses can change the outcome of matchups that were previously hits or blocks.

Worked Example — Equipment Bonuses: From the previous example, Soldier A was hit: Attack 6 vs Defense 5 = 1 damage. But Soldier A is equipped with S.A.P armor (+1 defense). The defense die increases from 5 to 6.

| Target    | Attack Die | Defense Die (after bonus) | Result                                |
|-----------|------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Soldier A | 6          | 5 + 1 = 6                 | BLOCKED! S.A.P armor saves Soldier A. |

Conversely: if the Attacker had a H.C.A.R-equipped soldier (+1 attack), the attack die would have been 7 vs 6 — a hit for 1 damage, punching through the armor.

## Step 4: Play Conspire Cards

After equipment bonuses are applied, both players may play Combat Conspire Cards (Guerrilla Warfare, Defender Instant Shield, Old School RPG, One Pulse Barrier) to alter the outcome.

### Order of play:

1. Defender plays Combat Conspire Cards first.
2. Attacker responds with their own Combat Conspire Cards second.

Each player may play any number of eligible Combat Conspire Cards. Tactical Conspire Cards cannot be played during this step.

| Example Conspire Card   | Effect                                |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Guerrilla Warfare       | Add 1d6 to your attack total          |
| Defender Instant Shield | Add 1d6 to your defense total         |
| Old School RPG          | Grant +1 attack to one soldier's die  |
| One Pulse Barrier       | Grant +1 defense to one soldier's die |



Tip: The Defender plays first — the Attacker always gets the last word. A shrewd Attacker can wait to see the Defender's cards before deciding whether to spend their own.

## Step 5: Resolve Damage

After all dice modifications and card effects are applied, calculate final damage for every matchup.

For each HIT (attack die > defense die):

- The difference between the final attack value and the final defense value equals the number of damage pegs inserted into the divots on that defending H.A.M.S.'s base.
- Each base has 3 blood-drop divots. Insert one red peg per point of damage taken.
- Damage persists between turns. A wounded H.A.M.S. keeps its pegs until healed by a card effect or ability (which removes pegs from the divots).

### Combat Winner

The player who inflicted more total damage across all matchups in this combat is the combat winner.

### Death Threshold

A H.A.M.S. can sustain a maximum of 3 damage pegs. When a soldier would receive a 4th damage peg, that soldier dies.

Worked Example: Soldier A already carries 2 damage pegs from a previous turn. In this combat, Soldier A's matchup results in a HIT dealing 2 damage. Soldier A now has  $2 + 2 = 4$  damage pegs -> Soldier A is killed.

## Step 6: Counterattack

After all damage is resolved, check every defender's matchup for a potential Counterattack.

**Counterattack Trigger: Any defending soldier whose defense die beat the attack die by 3 or more earns a Counterattack.**

| Defender  | Attack Die | Defense Die | Difference        | Result                            |
|-----------|------------|-------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Soldier A | 6          | 5           | -1 (attacker won) | No counterattack                  |
| Soldier B | 4          | 4           | +0 for defender   | No counterattack (difference < 3) |
| Soldier C | 1          | 6           | +5 for defender   | COUNTERATTACK triggered           |

When a Counterattack is triggered:

1. The counterattacking defender becomes the Attacker in a new mini-combat round.
2. All normal combat rules apply (Steps 1–6), using only the counterattacking soldier(s) and the original attacker's soldiers they were matched against.
3. Counterattacks can chain — but each successive counterattack suffers a cumulative -1 Combat Fatigue penalty to all dice rolls. The 1st counterattack has no penalty, the 2nd has -1, the 3rd has -2, etc. This makes extended chains increasingly unlikely to trigger.



Worked Example — Counterattack: Continuing from the earlier combat: The Attacker assigned a 1 against Soldier C's defense of 6. Difference:  $6 - 1 = 5$  ( $\geq 3$ ) — Counterattack triggered! Mini-Combat Round (Chain 1 — no fatigue penalty): Soldier C is now the Attacker. Both sides roll 1d6:

| Matchup                        | Attack Die | Defense Die | Result                      |
|--------------------------------|------------|-------------|-----------------------------|
| Soldier C vs Original Attacker | 2          | 5           | BLOCKED (defense wins by 3) |

The original attacker's defense die (5) beat the attack die (2) by 3 — exactly the threshold. Another Counterattack triggers! Mini-Combat Round (Chain 2 — Combat Fatigue: -1 to all dice): The original attacker strikes back. Both roll 1d6, but subtract 1 from each roll (minimum 1):

| Matchup                    | Raw Roll | Fatigue | Final Die | Result         |
|----------------------------|----------|---------|-----------|----------------|
| Original Attacker (attack) | 4        | -1      | 3         |                |
| Soldier C (defense)        | 3        | -1      | 2         |                |
| Result                     |          |         | 3 vs 2    | HIT (1 damage) |

Difference is only 1 — no further counterattack. The chain ends.

# Death in W.A.R H.A.M.S

When a H.A.M.S accumulates 4 or more damage pegs, the soldier is killed. Resolve immediately:

## 1. Lethal Hit Roll

The owning player rolls 1d6 to determine where the killing blow struck:

| Roll | Slot Hit       |
|------|----------------|
| 1    | Head           |
| 2    | Backpack       |
| 3    | Legs           |
| 4–5  | Chest          |
| 6    | Hands (weapon) |

## 2. Module Destroyed

Detach the equipment module from the struck slot and return it to the box (it becomes available for purchase again). If the struck slot is empty (no module equipped), no module is destroyed — proceed directly to salvage distribution.

## 3. Salvage Distribution

| Pick Order | Player                        | Action                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1st        | Owner (dead soldier's player) | Choose 1 remaining equipped module to keep — may immediately attach it to another existing soldier in the same Squad for free, provided that soldier is not outside of coherency |
| 2nd        | Attacker (killing player)     | Choose 1 remaining equipped module to take — may immediately attach it to one of their soldiers for free, provided that soldier is not outside of coherency                      |
| 3rd        | —                             | All remaining modules are left on the hex as salvage                                                                                                                             |

## 4. Salvage

Modules left on the hex may be picked up by any soldier occupying that hex during Phase 4: Salvage & Resource Gathering, Step 1 (Salvage Collection). Salvage collection happens before regular resource gathering. Salvaged modules can be equipped for free (the cost was already paid) — simply attach the module to the soldier's mini. Check the Equipment Display to confirm the module's identity and effect.

## 5. Coherency Check

After a death, check if any surviving squadmates are now beyond 2 hexes from all other squadmates. If so, those soldiers are disconnected — they fight alone (own dice only, no Squad-level BAC effects), identical to the J.J disconnection rules. Disconnected soldiers suffer a -1 penalty to all dice rolls (minimum 1) and must use their next Movement phase to move back within 2 hexes of a squadmate. Until they rejoin, they cannot benefit from effects like S.L.I.M.E crew, L.P.M spotting, or other Squad-level abilities.

# Civilian Damage Rule

When using area-of-effect weaponry — specifically S.L.I.M.E (mortar) or other artillery — on a hex that produces Local Favor (City or Village):

- All opposing players each gain 2 Local Favor resource tokens immediately.
- The attacking player loses ALL of their current Local Favor tokens.

Bombarding cities wins battles but loses hearts and minds.

## Separatist Combat

Separatist battles use the normal combat sequence with the exceptions listed in Phase 7: Separatists — Combat Rules, which is authoritative for who rolls their dice, penalties, hit points, mandatory combats, and base defenders.

## Special Weapon Rules

### B.A.S.R (Bolt Action Sniper Rifle) — Sniper Rifle

| One shot. One kill. Before anyone else fires. |                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Property                                      | Value                                                                 |
| Timing                                        | Fires before normal combat (pre-combat step)                          |
| Dice                                          | Roll 2d6, pick the higher result                                      |
| Target                                        | 1 specific soldier up to 2 hexes away. Target defends normally (1d6)  |
| Restriction                                   | Sniper does not participate in normal combat                          |
| Vulnerability                                 | While defending: both the sniper and the target get -1 to defense die |

### S.L.I.M.E (Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment) — Mortar

| Rain fire from a distance. |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Property                   | Value                                                                                                                                                               |
| Crew                       | Requires 2 soldiers                                                                                                                                                 |
| Dice                       | Roll 4d6                                                                                                                                                            |
| Target                     | An entire enemy Squad up to 3 hexes away                                                                                                                            |
| Restriction                | Mortar crew skips normal combat                                                                                                                                     |
| Vulnerability              | -1 defense when attacked directly                                                                                                                                   |
| Civilian Damage            | Targeting a City/Village hex triggers the Civilian Damage Rule: all opposing players gain 2 Local Favor; attacker loses all Local Favor (see §Civilian Damage Rule) |

### L.P.M (Laser Pointer Marker) — Laser Pointer Module

| Paint the target. Let the heavy weapons do the rest. |                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Property                                             | Value                                                    |
| Function                                             | Extends B.A.S.R and S.L.I.M.E effective range            |
| Mechanic                                             | Weapons may target enemies adjacent to the L.P.M carrier |
| Maximum Range                                        | 4 hexes total                                            |
| Restriction                                          | L.P.M carrier does not fire — they designate targets     |

## Bunker Rules

Bunker tokens are placed by the D.U.D.S (Deployable Unital Defense System) equipment module. Once deployed, a bunker becomes a permanent terrain feature on the hex.

| Rule        | Detail                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Placement   | Activate D.U.D.S to place a bunker token on the hex the soldier occupies. D.U.D.S module is removed from the soldier (one-use), freeing the backpack slot      |
| Effect      | +1 to all defense dice for any unit defending on this hex                                                                                                      |
| Ownership   | Bunkers are neutral fortifications — any unit on the hex benefits, regardless of faction                                                                       |
| Stacking    | 1 bunker per hex maximum                                                                                                                                       |
| Persistence | Bunker tokens remain on the hex until destroyed                                                                                                                |
| Destruction | An attacker who wins combat on a bunkered hex may choose to destroy the bunker (remove the token) instead of claiming the hex                                  |
| Bunker DP   | Deployer earns 2 DP permanently upon deployment. Whoever controls the bunkered hex earns an additional 2 DP (total 4 DP for deployer holding their own bunker) |

Tip: Bunkers alter the terrain permanently — place them on chokepoints you plan to hold, but beware: if you lose the hex, your enemies dig in behind your own fortifications.

## Combat Quick Reference

| Step       | Action                                                   | Who Acts |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Pre-Combat | Resolve B.A.S.R (sniper) and S.L.I.M.E (mortar) attacks  | Attacker |
| Step 1     | Roll attack & defense dice (1d6 per soldier)             | Both     |
| Step 2     | Attacker assigns matchups; Defender assigns defense dice | Both     |
| Step 3     | Apply equipment bonuses (+attack, +defense)              | Both     |
| Step 4     | Play Conspire Cards (Defender first, then Attacker)      | Both     |
| Step 5     | Resolve damage (attack - defense = damage pegs)          | —        |
| Step 6     | Check for Counterattacks (defense beat attack by 3+)     | Defender |

### Key Thresholds:

| Threshold                     | Value                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Damage pegs to kill a H.A.M.S | 4 (dies on the 4th peg)                                              |
| Counterattack trigger         | Defense beats attack by 3 or more (chains get -1 cumulative fatigue) |
| Separatist lives              | 1 (dies on any hit)                                                  |
| Separatist dice penalty       | -1 to all rolls (roaming only; base defenders roll full d6)          |

# BASIC ARMAMENT CARDS (BACs)

BACs are the weapons, armor, gadgets, and tactical systems that transform your H.A.M.S from expendable grunts into an unstoppable force.

## Card Anatomy

| Zone      | Location     | Description                                           |
|-----------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Name      | Top center   | The BAC's full military acronym designation           |
| Cost      | Top right    | Resource cost per soldier equipped                    |
| Slot      | Bottom left  | Equipment slot: Head, Backpack, Legs, Chest, or Hands |
| DP Value  | Bottom right | Dominance Points this card contributes while equipped |
| Card Text | Center       | The BAC's mechanical effect                           |

## Equipment Slots

Each soldier has 5 equipment slots, determined by die roll when a slot is targeted:

| Die Roll | Slot     |
|----------|----------|
| 1        | Head     |
| 2        | Backpack |
| 3        | Legs     |
| 4-5      | Chest    |
| 6        | Hands    |

Each soldier may carry 1 module per slot. A Squad may equip multiple BAC types, but no individual soldier may double up on a single slot.

## Module Identification & the Equipment Display

Every equipment module has a unique sculpt — an H.C.A.R rifle looks different from a B.A.S.R sniper, a S.A.P Helmet looks different from a S.H.A.D (Sensory Helmet, Advisory Drone) helmet. Each module also has its abbreviation engraved on the underside for confirmation.

When a BAC type is equipped for the first time in the game, place its BAC card face-up in the Equipment Display — a shared area near the board visible to all players. Place one reference module on top of the card so everyone can see what that module looks like.

The Equipment Display serves as the communal reference for all active equipment in the game:

| What you need to know            | Where to look                                                  |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| What does this module do?        | Equipment Display — read the BAC card                          |
| What is this module's DP value?  | Equipment Display — check the card                             |
| Which soldiers have this module? | Look at the minis — the sculpt matches the reference module    |
| Who owns which modules?          | The modules physically attached to each player's colored minis |

The modules on the minis are the source of truth — not cards, not boards. If a module is on your soldier, you have it. If it's not, you don't.

Tip: Any player can pick up a module from the board and compare its sculpt to the reference modules in the Equipment Display to identify it.

## Equipping Rules

- Choose a BAC card from your hand and pay the listed resource cost per soldier you wish to equip.
- If this BAC type is not yet in the Equipment Display, place the card face-up there and place one of your Control Flags on it to mark it as permanently unlocked. If it's already in the Equipment Display, discard the card and place your flag on the existing card.
- Attach the matching equipment module (physical magnetized part) to each equipped soldier's miniature in the correct slot.
- Modules = Truth: The physical modules on minis are the definitive record of who has what. The Equipment Display is for reference only.
- Flags are permanent: Once your Control Flag is placed on a BAC card in the Equipment Display, it stays for the rest of the game — even if all your soldiers carrying that module die. Your flag marks that you've unlocked that BAC type and can pay to equip it again.
- Exception — T.I.L.T.S (Tactical Ion Team Link Shield): Pay the listed cost per soldier as normal. During combat, two adjacent T.I.L.T.S soldiers may swap one attacker's assigned die between them. This ability is always active — no tapping required. No other backpack module may be equipped alongside T.I.L.T.S.
- S.A.P -> C.A.P Upgrade: Custom Armor Plating (C.A.P) requires trading in the corresponding S.A.P piece as part of the upgrade cost. Detach the S.A.P module from the mini and return it to the supply, then attach the C.A.P module.
- Armor Stacking: S.A.P and C.A.P pieces each grant their defense bonus independently (+1 per S.A.P piece, +2 per C.A.P piece). There are no set bonuses — equip as many or as few armor pieces as your strategy demands.
- Tapping: Some modules are Tapped (rotated 90° on the mini or marked with a tap token) when activated. A Tapped module cannot be used again until Untapped (recharged) — typically at a City or Spaceport for a resource cost.
- One-Shot: Modules marked as one-use (e.g., D.U.D.S) are removed from the soldier after activation, freeing the slot. The module is returned to the supply and no longer counts toward DP.

## Activating Modules

Modules with active abilities fall into two timing categories:

| Category       | When to Activate                                       | Examples                                                                                                       |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Combat Modules | During combat resolution at Step 3 (equipment bonuses) | N.I.N.J.A (Nir Ion Nullifier Jammer Aid; +3 defense die)                                                       |
| Field Modules  | During Phase 5 (Purchase & Equip) on your turn         | P.L.A.S.T.E.R (Personal Lasting Aid Surgical Treatment Enhancement Robot; heal damage), D.U.D.S (place bunker) |

- Untapping (recharging) a Tapped module is also done during Phase 5. The soldier must be at the required location (City or Spaceport) and you must pay the listed recharge cost.
- Passive bonuses (e.g., H.C.A.R +1 attack, S.A.P +1 defense) are always active and require no activation — they apply automatically during combat.

## Full BAC Card List (20 Types × 5 Copies = 100 Cards)

| Category | Abbr          | Full Name                                                 | Slot     | Cost                               | DP | Effect                                                                                                               |
|----------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Armor    | S.A.P Chest   | Standard Armor Plating Chest Piece                        | Chest    | 1 Oil, 1 Industry                  | 1  | This soldier gets +1 to its defense die                                                                              |
|          | S.A.P Helmet  | Standard Armor Plating Helmet                             | Head     | 1 Oil, 1 Industry                  | 1  | This soldier gets +1 to its defense die                                                                              |
|          | S.A.P Legs    | Standard Armor Plating Legs                               | Legs     | 1 Oil, 1 Industry                  | 1  | This soldier gets +1 to its defense die                                                                              |
|          | C.A.P Chest   | Custom Armor Plating Chest                                | Chest    | 1 S.A.P Chest + 1 LF, 1 Ind, 1 Oil | 4  | This soldier gets +2 to its defense die                                                                              |
|          | C.A.P Head    | Custom Armor Plating Helmet                               | Head     | 1 S.A.P Head + 1 LF, 1 Int, 1 Oil  | 4  | This soldier gets +2 to its defense die                                                                              |
|          | C.A.P Legs    | Custom Armor Plating Legs                                 | Legs     | 1 S.A.P Legs + 1 LF, 1 Elec, 1 Oil | 4  | This soldier gets +2 to its defense die                                                                              |
| Weapons  | H.C.A.R       | Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle                               | Hands    | 1 Ind, 1 Oil                       | 2  | +1 attack die                                                                                                        |
|          | R.S.G         | Repeating Shotgun                                         | Hands    | 1 Oil, 1 LF                        | 2  | Within 1 hex: +2 attack. Beyond 1 hex: -1 attack                                                                     |
|          | P.C.S.M.G     | Projectile Correcting Sub Machine Gun                     | Hands    | 1 Elec, 1 Ind, 1 Int               | 3  | Within 1 hex: roll 3d6 pick highest                                                                                  |
| Heavy    | B.A.S.R       | Bolt Action Sniper Rifle                                  | Hands    | 1 Oil, 1 Int, 1 Ind                | 4  | Pre-combat: 2d6 pick higher, target 1 soldier up to 2 hexes. Sniper skips combat. Both get -1 defense                |
|          | S.L.I.M.E     | Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment               | Backpack | 1 Ind, 2 Oil, 2 LF                 | 5  | 2-soldier crew. 4d6 normal matchups, target squad up to 3 hexes. Crew skips combat. -1 defense. Civilian Damage Rule |
| Support  | P.L.A.S.T.E.R | Personal Lasting Aid Surgical Treatment Enhancement Robot | Chest    | 1 Elec, 1 LF                       | 2  | Heal up to 2 damage on any soldier same hex. Tap. Recharge: 1 Elec                                                   |
|          | B.E.A.R       | Battlefield Extraction Airlift Rover                      | Chest    | 1 Oil, 1 Ind, 1 Elec               | 3  | +1 extra resource from same hex during Phase 4                                                                       |
|          | L.P.M         | Laser Pointer Marker                                      | Backpack | 1 Elec, 1 LF, 1 Int                | 4  | B.A.S.R/S.L.I.M.E target enemies near L.P.M carrier. Max 4 hex                                                       |
|          | D.U.D.S       | Deployable Unital Defense System                          | Backpack | 1 LF, 1 Oil, 1 Ind                 | 2  | Place bunker: +1 all defense dice. One-use, frees slot. 2 DP deploy + 2 DP to hex controller                         |
| Tech     | J.J           | Jump Jets                                                 | Legs     | 1 Ind, 1 Int                       | 2  | Move 2 hexes. May override coherency (fights alone)                                                                  |
|          | S.H.A.D       | Sensory Helmet, Advisory Drone                            | Head     | 2 Int, 1 Elec                      | 5  | Attacker must reveal Conspire cards before combat                                                                    |
|          | P.A.E.H       | Personal Accuracy Enhancement Helmet                      | Head     | 1 LF, 1 Elec, 1 Int                | 4  | +1 attack die while also equipped with H.C.A.R                                                                       |
|          | N.I.N.J.A     | Nir Ion Nullifier Jammer Aid                              | Legs     | 1 Int, 1 Elec                      | 2  | +3 to one defense die. Tap. Recharge: 2 Elec                                                                         |
|          | T.I.L.T.S     | Tactical Ion Team Link Shield                             | Backpack | 1 Elec, 1 Ind, 2 Int               | 5  | Adjacent T.I.L.T.S pair swap one attacker die. Always active. No other backpack                                      |

# CONSPIRING

A player may forfeit a Squad's Movement (Phase 2) OR Combat (Phase 3) to Conspire. The choice is made per Squad — some Squads may move and fight normally while others Conspire.

## Drawing Conspire Cards

1. Draw 3 cards from the Conspire Deck.
  2. Keep 1 card, discard the other 2 face-down.
  3. If a drawn card states otherwise (e.g., "keep 2"), follow that card's instructions.
- A single Squad may Conspire in both Phase 2 and Phase 3 of the same turn (forfeiting both movement and combat), drawing twice.

**Hand Limit:** A player may hold a maximum of 7 Conspire Cards. At the end of your turn, if you have more than 7, discard down to 7 (your choice which to discard).

## Playing Conspire Cards

- Conspire Cards fall into two timing categories:
- Combat Cards (Guerrilla Warfare, Defender Instant Shield, Old School RPG, One Pulse Barrier):**
- Played only during combat at Step 4 of combat resolution.
  - Defender plays first, then Attacker responds.
  - Each player may play any number of eligible Combat Conspire Cards.
- Tactical Cards (all other Conspire Cards — resource exchange, free resource, territory control, etc.):**
- May be played at any time — during your turn, another player's turn, or between phases.
  - Effects resolve instantly.
- Pay any listed cost when you play the card.

## Deck Exhaustion

When the Conspire Deck is empty, shuffle the discard pile to form a new deck.

## Full Conspire Card List (24 Types × 3 Copies = 72 Cards)

### Resource Exchange (1 Cost -> 3 Gain)

| Name                                | Cost           | Effect                      | Copies |
|-------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------|--------|
| Abandoned Satellite Control Station | 1 Electricity  | Exchange for 3 Intelligence | 3      |
| Build a Wind Farm                   | 1 Industry     | Exchange for 3 Electricity  | 3      |
| Raid an Oil Cache                   | 1 Intelligence | Exchange for 3 Oil          | 3      |
| Factory Takeover                    | 1 Local Favor  | Exchange for 3 Industry     | 3      |
| Build a Follower Camp               | 1 Industry     | Exchange for 3 Local Favor  | 3      |

### Free Resource (Gain 1, Chance for Bonus)

| Name                          | Cost | Effect                                                                                        | Copies |
|-------------------------------|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Recruit Eager Volunteers      | Free | Gain 1 Local Favor. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose  | 3      |
| Scout Ahead                   | Free | Gain 1 Intelligence. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose | 3      |
| Tap into Oil Reserves         | Free | Gain 1 Oil. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose          | 3      |
| Proper Planning               | Free | Gain 1 Industry. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose     | 3      |
| Tap into the Local Power Grid | Free | Gain 1 Electricity. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose  | 3      |



## Combat

| Name                    | Cost          | Effect                           | Copies |
|-------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------|--------|
| Guerrilla Warfare       | 1 Local Favor | Add 1d6 to an attack combat roll | 3      |
| Defender Instant Shield | 1 Oil         | Add 1d6 to a defense combat roll | 3      |
| Old School RPG          | Free          | +1 to an attack combat roll      | 3      |
| One Pulse Barrier       | Free          | +1 to a defense combat roll      | 3      |

## Tactical

| Name                             | Cost                          | Effect                                                                                                                                                | Copies |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Deal with Local Militia          | 3 Local Favor                 | Spawn 3 militia on a hex within 2 hexes of your soldier. They immediately attack one adjacent enemy Squad, then are removed (see Militia Rules below) | 3      |
| A Rough Night                    | 1 Local Favor, 2 Intelligence | Target any Squad: immobilized AND -1 combat rolls next turn                                                                                           | 3      |
| Traveling Med Bay                | X resources (X <= 3)          | Exchange any 1 resource to heal 1 damage peg. Repeat up to 3×                                                                                         | 3      |
| Deal with a Local Representative | 1 any resource                | Conspire again, keep 2 cards instead of 1                                                                                                             | 3      |
| Hack a PortNet Relay             | 1 Intelligence                | Take 1 face-up BAC from the Planet Bound Area into your hand. Immediately refill the empty slot from the Spaceport Deck                               | 3      |

## Territory Control (Require Controlling 2+ of a Resource Type)

| Name                     | Condition                     | Effect                                                    | Copies |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Knowledge is Power       | Control 2+ Intelligence tiles | Gain 2 BACs from Spaceport Deck                           | 3      |
| Civilian Goods Transport | Control 2+ Local Favor tiles  | Gain any 4 resource tokens                                | 3      |
| Black Gold Syndicate     | Control 2+ Oil tiles          | Draw 2 Conspire cards (keep both)                         | 3      |
| At the Cover of Darkness | Control 2+ Electricity tiles  | Steal from opponent: 2 resources, OR 1 Conspire, OR 1 BAC | 3      |
| Factory Cost Savings     | Control 2+ Industry tiles     | Equip a BAC free for 2 soldiers. Pay normal cost for rest | 3      |

# MILITIA

Militia are temporary local fighters summoned by the Deal with Local Militia Conspire Card. They are not a permanent force — they attack once and disperse.

| Rule         | Detail                                                                                                                                |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spawning     | Place 3 militia on a hex within 2 hexes of one of your soldiers. Spawning is mandatory — the card effect cannot be partially resolved |
| Components   | Use spare Separatist miniatures. If none are available, use any substitute (coins, tokens, dice, etc.)                                |
| Combat       | Militia immediately attack one adjacent enemy Squad using normal combat rules                                                         |
| Dice Penalty | -1 to all dice (same as Separatists)                                                                                                  |
| Hit Points   | 1 life each — any hit kills instantly                                                                                                 |
| No Equipment | Militia carry no BACs and have no equipment slots                                                                                     |
| Dispersal    | All militia are removed from the board after their attack resolves, regardless of outcome                                             |

Note: Militia act on the summoning player's behalf — the summoning player assigns their attack dice and chooses matchups.

# CONTROLLING TERRITORY

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## Claiming a Hex

Claim is resolved automatically at the end of Phase 2 (Movement) and again at the end of Phase 3 (Combat) — see the Claim Hexes sub-steps in each phase. The rule in both places:

For every hex containing one or more of your soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place one of your Control Flags on that hex. If an opposing flag is already there, return it to that opponent's supply and replace it with yours. If your own flag is already there, leave it.

This applies to resource-producing hexes, Spaceport Drop Zones, Separatist Bases (once conquered — all 7 defenders killed), and Terrain hexes.

Once placed, a flag stays even after your Squad leaves — the hex remains under your control until an opponent's Squad enters it and re-claims it via the same Phase 2 or Phase 3 step. Contested hexes (both your and an enemy's soldiers on the same hex) skip flag placement until Phase 3 Combat resolves the occupant.

## End-of-Round Bonus

Important: This happens at the END OF THE ROUND — after ALL players have completed their turns. It does NOT happen at the end of each individual player's turn.

At the end of each round (after all players have completed their turns), any uncollected resource tokens on your controlled hexes are added to your supply. Additionally, any spaceport hexes you control with container markers grant you the BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot. See the End of Round step in the Turn Structure for full details.

Territory collection is resolved simultaneously for all players once the final player's turn (including Phase 7) is complete.

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# HOW TO WIN

Three paths lead to victory. The first player to achieve any condition wins immediately — even during another player's turn.

## Victory 1: Spaceport Domination

Control the required number of Spaceport Landing Zones:

| Players | Spaceports Needed |
|---------|-------------------|
| 2       | 5 of 6            |
| 3–4     | 4 of 6            |

Your corporate HQ dispatches a full battalion. With the majority of orbital access locked down, rival corporations can no longer resupply — they flee off-world in panic. You win command of the planet.

## Victory 2: Military Supremacy

Field 4 full Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each (28 soldiers total) and hold them for 1 full round.

When you reach 28 soldiers, declare Military Supremacy at the end of your turn. If you still have 28 or more soldiers at the start of your next turn, you win. Every opponent gets one full turn to try to knock your numbers down before the victory is confirmed.

**Tie: If two or more players both hold 28+ soldiers when checks resolve, the player with the highest Dominance Points (DP) wins. If DP is also tied, continue playing until the tie is broken.**

Your overwhelming military presence renders further conflict pointless. Rival HQs withdraw. You are promoted to conquer bigger, richer planets.

## Victory 3: Dominance

Accumulate 50 Dominance Points (DP).

DP come from equipped BAC cards — each BAC's DP value counts toward your total as long as the card remains equipped and the soldier carrying it is alive. The local population rallies behind your banner and crowns you their sovereign.

Tracking DP: Count the DP values of all equipment modules currently attached to your living soldiers (check the Equipment Display for each module's DP value). If a soldier dies and their module is destroyed or salvaged by another player, that DP is lost.

# QUICK REFERENCE CARD

## Soldier Equipment Slots

| Die Roll | Slot     |
|----------|----------|
| 1        | Head     |
| 2        | Backpack |
| 3        | Legs     |
| 4–5      | Chest    |
| 6        | Hands    |

## Resource Colors

| Resource     | Color  | Depiction           | Hex Tile       | Token             |
|--------------|--------|---------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| Oil          | Black  | Fuel                | Oil Rig        | Oil Drum          |
| Electricity  | Yellow | Electricity Bolt    | Power Plant    | Lightning Bolt    |
| Intelligence | Blue   | Intel Operator Room | Radar Dish     | Transmitting Wave |
| Industry     | Red    | Industry Factory    | Factory        | Hammer            |
| Local Favor  | Green  | Militia Base        | City / Village | Recruit           |

## Turn Phase Summary

| # | Phase               | Key Action                                                                                               |
|---|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Resource Production | Roll 3d6, place resource tokens on matching hexes                                                        |
| 2 | Movement            | Move each soldier up to 1 hex (or Conspire instead). Squad coherency: stay within 2 hexes of a squadmate |
| 3 | Combat              | Declare attacks against enemies within 2 hexes (only engaged soldiers roll)                              |
| 4 | Resource Gathering  | Collect tokens from occupied/adjacent hexes. Priority: winner -> loser -> active player (if no combat)   |
| 5 | Purchase & Equip    | Buy and equip BACs, recruit soldiers, create Squads                                                      |
| 6 | Trade               | Trade resource tokens freely with other players                                                          |
| 7 | Separatists         | Uprising -> consume -> move toward producing hexes -> resolve combats                                    |

## Key Costs

| Action                   | Cost                                                     | Location          |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Recruit 1 Soldier        | 1 Local Favor + 1 Oil + 1 Industry + 1 Electricity       | City              |
| Create New Squad (min 5) | 5× soldier cost                                          | City              |
| Draw from Spaceport Deck | 3 same-type resource tokens                              | Spaceport or City |
| Conspire                 | Forfeit 1 Squad's Movement (Phase 2) or Combat (Phase 3) | Anywhere          |
| Untap P.L.A.S.T.E.R      | 1 Electricity                                            | City or Spaceport |
| Untap N.I.N.J.A          | 2 Electricity                                            | City or Spaceport |

## Combat Quick Reference

| Step | Action                                                                                        |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pre  | Resolve B.A.S.R (sniper) and S.L.I.M.E (mortar)                                               |
| 1    | Both sides roll 1d6 per engaged soldier. Larger side picks best dice                          |
| 2    | Attacker assigns dice to defenders; Defender aligns defense dice                              |
| 3    | Apply equipment bonuses (+attack, +defense)                                                   |
| 4    | Play Combat Conspire Cards (defender first, then attacker)                                    |
| 5    | Attack > Defense = HIT (difference = damage). 4 damage = death -> roll d6 for slot -> salvage |
| 6    | Defense beats attack by 3+ = Counterattack (chains: -1 cumulative fatigue)                    |

## Victory Conditions

| Path                 | Condition                                         |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Spaceport Domination | Control 4 of the 6 Spaceport Landing Zones        |
| Military Supremacy   | Field 4 full Squads of 7 H.A.M.S (28 soldiers)    |
| Dominance            | Accumulate 50 Dominance Points from equipped BACs |

Name your world. Deploy your H.A.M.S. Fight for Dominance.

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